

Access lets you do all this and much more. Let's get on with learning Access.

6.1.1 New Features In Access 2003

As with all applications of Microsoft Office 2003, there are new features that have been added to Access 2003. Let's take a look at these features briefly.

1. Access is an Relational Database Management System (RDBMS). We will explain the meaning of this term once we start using it, but for now it would suffice to say that a new feature has been introduced in Access 2003 that makes it easier for users to identify dependencies in tables and how modifications in the content will affect the data.
2. New 'smart tags' handle the errors that you may make when using Access, and point out possible corrections for such errors.
3. Copying 'linked tables' has been made easier, and copying a 'relational table' from one database to another is much easier now.
4. A failsafe database backup feature has been introduced, which will let you backup entire databases using a menu option.

6.1.2 Using Access 2003

Similar to all other members of the Microsoft Office 2003 suite, you can click on **Start > Programs > Microsoft Office > Microsoft Office Access 2003** to start Access. When you start Access, you will be greeted with only a task pane and an empty window.

Unlike other Office products such as Word, Excel and PowerPoint, working in Access can seem comparatively overwhelming. Working with databases can be easy when you start, but can become tiring after some time. Also, creating a database from scratch will take more time and concentration, and sometimes this alone turns off many users. Hence, in our case, we will rely on the Access 2003 Wizards to take care of our first database.